beyond audible perception of the user are cut off.

Codecs such as AAC, Ogg Vorbis etc. use different algorithms. For instance, AAC is based on the MPEG-2/-4 standard and can use be used as a lossless or lossy compression technique as required. So which audio codec is right for you? Read on to find out.

Choosing the right codec

Codecs are abundantly available on the Internet and are included in applications that let you use them to your advantage. In this section, before we get into using these codecs, let's get one thing clear. If you are making a recording of your own song or audio track, it is best to do it uncompressed in a format such as .wav or .pcm. If you are looking to make archives of your old tapes or vinyl LP's then you can be sure that using the above mentioned file formats will help you get the best results. But the downside is that the file size will go for a toss as saving a 4 minute audio file in the .wav format will cost you about 20MB and above in terms of disk space. As an option to this, you can use the lossless codecs that will help you save a few MB's per file. But overall, the file size will still be larger.

Next up is the part where protecting your audio files comes in. DRM (Digital Rights Management) cannot be applied for MP3 files but it can be for Ogg Vorbis (Experimental), WMP (Windows Media Player) and AAC . Therefore, if you are making an original recording, you can use AAC or WMP to restrict your recording from being pirated.

This section will only talk about software that are freely available and we are limiting ourselves to choosing between only four codecs. These are Windows Media Audio, MP3, Ogg Vorbis and AAC. We will be using applications that let us encode a single file into any of these formats. Please refer to the workshop at the end of this chapter for the results of the test that we have performed here.